SUKHUN KANG

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

University of California, Santa Barbara *2023–Present*
Assistant Professor of Technology Management

EDUCATION

London Business School *2023*
Ph.D. in Strategy and Entrepreneurship
Dissertation: Essays on Innovation Commercialization
Committee: Gary Dushnitsky (chair), Sungyong Chang, Sendil Ethiraj, Olenka Kacperczyk, Abhishek Nagaraj

University of Southern California
M.S. in Entrepreneurship and Innovation (*Focus*: Entrepreneurial strategy) *2016*
M.S. in Computer Engineering (*Focus*: Computer architecture) *2010*

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign *2007*
B.S. in Computer Engineering

PUBLICATIONS

3. **Uncovering Seeding Trials: Examining Non-Scientific Purposes in Clinical Trials** (with Ivan Lin and Sungyong Chang)
BMJ Evidence-Based Medicine (2026, Online First) [link]

2. **Implementation of 21st Century Cures Act Expanded Access Policies Requirements** (with Sungyong Chang, Joseph Ross, and Jennifer Miller)
Clinical Pharmacology & Therapeutics (2021) [link]

1. **Entrepreneurship, Innovation, and Political Competition: How the Public Sector Helps the Sharing Economy Create Value** (with Yongwook Paik and Robert Seamans)
Strategic Management Journal (2019) [link]

WORKING PAPERS

When Do Firms Provide Early Access to Investigational Drugs? Evidence from Expanded Access in the Oncology Drug Market 1990–2020 (with Sungyong Chang) [link]
(*2nd Round Revise & Resubmit*)

Revealed Relatedness: How New Mapping Criteria Reshape Organizational Search
(*2nd Round Revise & Resubmit*)
- 2023 AOM Annual Meeting Best Paper Proceedings
- 2024 Runner-up for ISA Giarratani Rising Star Award

Bridges or Barriers? How Venture Capital Portfolio Ties Shape Startups' Market Entry (with Sarath Balachandran and Sungyong Chang) [link]
(*1st Round Revise & Resubmit*)
- 2025 AOM Annual Meeting Best Paper Proceedings

- 2025 AOM Sumantra Ghoshal Research and Practice Award
- 2025 AOM STR Distinguished Paper Award in Corporate and International Strategy

Data Privacy Regulation and Innovation (with Jennifer Kao) [link]
(*1st Round Revise & Resubmit*)
- 2026 AOM TIM Best Conference Paper Award, Finalist
- 2026 AOM Annual Meeting Best Paper Proceedings
- 2026 Runner-up for ISA Babbage Best Paper in Industrial Innovation Policy Award

Selective Catch-Up in Innovation: Evidence from the Chinese Biopharmaceutical Industry (with Sandra Barbosu)

Do Biomedical Researchers Study Topics Related to Their Own Ethnicity? Evidence from the NIH (with Wesley Greenblatt and Young Hou)

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Attention Triage in Sequential Innovation (with Sandra Barbosu and Sungyong Chang)
- 2026 ISA Best Paper in Innovation and Entrepreneurship Award

Orchestrating an Ecosystem of Innovative Startups: Ex-Ante and Ex-Post Actions and Orchestrator's Performance (with Gary Dushnitsky)

AWARDS & HONORS

- Sebastian Hoenen Research Prize, SEI Consortium, 2026
- AOM TIM Best Conference Paper Award, Finalist, 2026
- Swildens Family Faculty Fellowship, UCSB, 2026–2029
- ISA Babbage Best Paper in Industrial Innovation Policy Award, Runner-up, 2026
- ISA Best Paper in Innovation and Entrepreneurship Award, 2026
- AOM Sumantra Ghoshal Research and Practice Award, 2025
- AOM STR Distinguished Paper Award in Corporate and International Strategy, 2025
- University of California Regents' Junior Faculty Fellowship, 2025
- ISA Giarratani Rising Star Award, Runner-up, 2024
- AOM TIM Dissertation Award, Finalist, 2024
- AOM STR Dissertation Award, Finalist, 2024
- Sir James Ball PhD Prize, LBS, 2022
- Organization Science/INFORMS Dissertation Proposal Competition, Finalist (one of 8 selected from 100+ proposals), 2022
- Best Reviewer Award, AOM (TIM), 2021
- Best Reviewer Award, AOM (ENT), 2019

GRANTS *indicates co-investigator

- Swildens Family Faculty Fellowship, UCSB, 2026–2029 ($4K/year)
- Faculty Career Development Award, UCSB, 2026 ($7.5K)
- University of California Regents' Junior Faculty Fellowship, 2025 ($7.5K)
- Faculty Travel Grant, UCSB, 2023, 2024, 2025
- Proposal Writing for Success (PROWESS) Grant, UCSB, 2024
- Strategy Research Foundation (SRF) Dissertation Research Grant, SMS, 2022–2023 ($4K)
- Wheeler Institute for Business and Development Research Grant, LBS, 2021 ($10K)
- Wheeler Institute for Business and Development Research Grant, LBS, 2020*
- Institute of Innovation and Entrepreneurship Research Grant, LBS, 2020*

- Wheeler Institute for Business and Development Research Grant, LBS, 2019*
- Institute of Innovation and Entrepreneurship Research Grant, LBS, 2019 ($5K)
- Fellowship for Doctoral Students, LBS, 2016–2023

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

2026–27: SMS Berlin; People and Organizations Conference; SEI Consortium; AOM Philadelphia

2025–26: ISA Washington DC; Strategy Science Conference; UC Merced Yosemite Retreat in Entrepreneurship and Innovation; University of California, Santa Barbara, Technology and Organizations Research Seminar (TORS); Entrepreneurship & Innovation Policy Virtual Seminar Series; Utah Winter Strategy Conference; UT Austin Technology and Entrepreneurship Conference; Duke Fuqua Strategy Junior Faculty Conference; SMS San Francisco; IQVIA Institute Research Forum; University of Washington, West Coast Research Symposium; FDA's Economics Brownbag; HIWG Research Chat; AOM Copenhagen

2024–25: Harvard Medical School, Program On Regulation, Therapeutics, And Law (PORTAL) Guest Lecture Series; ISA Boston; UCLA, Seminar on Pharmaceutical Economics and Policy; UC Merced, Economics Department Seminar; SoCal Strategy/OT Workshop; Korea University, International Business Department Seminar; Troesh Entrepreneurship Conference; USC, Research Roundtable on Platform Dynamics; International Conference on Entrepreneurship Ecosystem; UCLA, Price Center Workshop in Entrepreneurship and Innovation; University of Oregon, West Coast Research Symposium; AOM Chicago

2023–24: HIWG Research Chat; ISA Sacramento; UCLA, Price Center Workshop in Entrepreneurship and Innovation; University of Maryland, Smith Entrepreneurship Research Conference; Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST) College of Business, Technology/Organization/Strategy Department Seminar; USC, SoCal Strategy/OT Workshop; University of California, Riverside, Management Department Seminar; University of California, Santa Barbara, Technology and Organizations Research Seminar (TORS); SMS Toronto; AOM Boston

2022–23: Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition, Workshop on the Organisation, Economics and Policy of Scientific Research; University of Sussex Business School, SPRU Freeman Friday Seminar; University of California, Santa Barbara, Technology Management Seminar; National University of Singapore (NUS), Strategy and Policy Seminar; HIWG Research Chat; Global Conference on Regulatory Science; SMS London; AOM Seattle

2021–22: CCC Doctoral Conference; Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference; IP & Innovation PhD Seminar; East Coast Doctoral Conference; Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium; SMS Virtual; Research Policy Conference; DRUID Annual Meeting; AOM Virtual; IP & Innovation PhD Seminar; Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference

2020–21 and earlier: SMS Virtual; People and Organizations Conference; Trans-Atlantic Doctoral Conference; West Coast Research Symposium

OTHER PUBLICATIONS, CASES, AND MEDIA

Clinical Trials That Are Actually Marketing Ploys Targeting Doctors: How Seeding Trials Put Profit over Patients (with I. Lin and S. Chang)
The Conversation (2026) [link]

Behind the Scenes of a YouTube Mega-Hit: Baby Shark, The Pinkfong Company, and What's Next (with A. Nagaraj)
Berkeley Haas Case (2025) [link]

Measuring Biopharmaceutical Innovation in the Modern Era (with S. Barbosu, S. Chang, and F. David)
The Incidental Economist (2025) [link]

Conversation with Sukhun Kang on access to medicines
The PI-Squared Initiative (The Burnes Center for Social Change at Northeastern University Podcast) (2025) [link]

Why should collaboration enhance oncology drug innovation?
Think at London Business School (The Why Podcast) (2023) [link]

WearMon: Reliability Monitoring Using Adaptive Critical Path Testing (with B. Zandian, W. Dweik, T. Punihaole, and M. Annavaram)
IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (2010)

Magellan: A Search and Machine Learning-Based Framework for Fast Multi-Core Design Space Exploration and Optimization (with R. Kumar)
Design, Automation and Test in Europe (2008)

TEACHING

UC Santa Barbara, Technology Management:
Instructor, TMP412, "Technology Strategy," Master's-level course, 2025–Present
Rating: 4.7/5 (Winter 2026)
Instructor, TMP120, "Strategy," Undergraduate-level course, 2023–Present
Rating: 4.5/5 (Winter 2024); 4.8/5 (Winter 2025); 4.8/5 (Winter 2026)

London Business School, Strategy and Entrepreneurship:
Teaching Assistant, Executive Education, "Developing Strategy for Value Creation," 2021
Grader, C002, "Strategic Management," 2017

University of Southern California:
Instructor, EE201, "Introduction to Digital Design," 2008–2010
Teaching Assistant, ACAD182, "Case Studies in Innovation," 2015
Teaching Assistant, EE560, "Digital System Design," 2009–2010
Teaching Assistant, EE557, "Advanced Computer Architecture," 2008
Grader, GSBA550, "Entrepreneurship," 2016

SERVICE

Editorial Review Board:
Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal, 2026–Present
Organization Science, 2025–Present

Ad-hoc Refereeing:

California Management Review; Clinical Pharmacology & Therapeutics; Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice; Journal of Business Venturing; Journal of Management Studies; Journal of Public Economics; Management Science; National Science Foundation; Research Policy; Strategic Management Journal; Strategy Science; Socio-Economic Review
(Conferences) AOM Annual Meetings; AOM TIM Best Conference Paper Award; AOM TIM Dissertation Award; Organization Science/INFORMS Dissertation Proposal Competition; SMS Conferences

Affiliations:

- Health Innovation Lab (HIL), Founder and Co-director, 2024–Present
- Health Innovation Working Group (HIWG), Co-founder and Organizer, 2021–Present
- Working Group on Compassionate Use & Preapproval Access (CUPA) at NYU, Member, 2021–Present

Professional Service:

- *Strategic Management Society*, Rep-at-Large of Knowledge and Innovation IG, 2026–Present
- *Academy of Management*, Research Committee of STR Division, 2025–Present
- *Strategic Management Society*, Rep-at-Large of Research Methods Community, 2025–Present
- *Industry Studies Association*, Giarratani Rising Star Award Committee, 2025
- *International Rare Diseases Research Consortium (IRDiRC)*, Member of Task Force on Funding Models to Support the Spectrum of Rare Disease Research and Development, 2023–2024
- *Working Group on Compassionate Use & Preapproval Access (CUPA) at NYU*, Speaker
  - A panel on Expanded Access at CUPA Webinar, 2023
  - A panel on Advanced Topics in Expanded Access at CUPA Webinar, 2023
  - A panel on Expanded Access at CUPACON, 2022
- *LBS*, Strategy and Entrepreneurship Area PhD Committee, 2018

Conference Organization:

- Co-organizer, Virtual Webinar on Agentic AI in Strategic Management Research, SMS, 2026
- Co-organizer, PDW on the Frontiers in Organizational Search, AOM, 2026
- Co-organizer, West Coast Research Symposium, Doctoral Consortium, 2025
- Co-organizer, Conference Extension on Strategy and Innovation in Pharmaceutical Industry, SMS, 2025
- Co-organizer, Managing Your Dissertation Workshop, AOM, 2025
- Co-organizer, PDW on Strategy and Innovation in Pharmaceutical Industry, AOM, 2025
- Co-organizer, PDW on Strategy and Innovation in Pharmaceutical Industry, AOM, 2024
- Co-organizer, PDW on the Empirical Research on Organizational Search, AOM, 2024
- Co-organizer, PDW on Strategy and Innovation in Pharmaceutical Industry, AOM, 2023
- Co-organizer, PDW on the Landscape of Research on Organizational Search, AOM, 2022
- Co-organizer, Presenter symposium on Strategy in Pharmaceutical Industry, AOM, 2022
- Co-organizer, Panel symposium on Science and Firm Strategy, AOM, 2021
- Co-organizer, Presenter symposium on Where Do Ecosystems Come From?, AOM, 2021

Service to UCSB:

- UCSB, Faculty Legislature (Senate) Representative, 2024–Present
- Technology Management Department, Social Committee, 2023–Present
- College of Engineering, Faculty Search Committee, 2023–2024

Mentoring:
- *AOM*, STR Dissertation Consortium Mentor, 2026
- *UCSB*, McNair Scholars Program Mentor, 2025–Present
- *UCSB*, Research Mentorship Program Mentor, 2025
- *West Coast Research Symposium*, Doctoral Consortium Mentor, 2024–2025
- *CancerX*, Accelerator Mentor, 2024–2025

STUDENTS ADVISED

Current PhD:
- Masoom Suchdeo (UCSB PhD): Committee Member for Doctoral Thesis
- Mostafa Khoshbash (UCSB PhD): Committee Member for Doctoral Thesis
- Zerin Dong (UC Merced PhD): External Committee Member for Oral Examination

Undergraduates:
- Fan Ye (UCSB), Research Assistant, Harvard Medical School
- Janice Jiang (UCSB), MS in Biostatistics, Harvard University
- Sean Wang (UCSB), Data Scientist, Applied Materials
- Ivan Lin (UCSB), Project Engineer, Leed Electric Inc.
- Kuan-I (Brian) Lu (UCSB), Master of Business Analytics, MIT
- Pramukh Shankar (UCSB), MS in Applied Urban Science and Informatics, NYU Tandon School of Engineering
- Carter Kulm (UCSB), MS in Data Science, UT Austin
- Amy Ji (UCSB), IQVIA

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Primer Accelerator *2016*
Intern, Los Angeles, CA, USA

City of Glendale *2015*
MBA Intern, Glendale, CA, USA

Samsung Electronics *2012–2014*
Engineer, Yongin, South Korea

I&C Technology *2010–2012*
Research Engineer, Seoul, South Korea

Egghead *2010*
Founder, Seoul, South Korea

LG Electronics *2007*
Intern, Seoul, South Korea

PERSONAL

- Languages: English (fluent); Korean (native)
- Citizenship: United States; Republic of Korea

Professional Memberships:
- Academy of Management, Member, 2017–Present
- Strategic Management Society, Member, 2017–Present

Last Updated: November 2026